

# Rainforests

Tropical rainforests are rich habitats for a huge variety of plants and animals. Enter a hot, damp, and shady world.

## Time for the umbrella

A rainforest is warm and sticky, with frequent downpours. The trees take up much of the rain, but water vapour soon evaporates from their leaves, filling the air with moisture.

Parakeet

Orang-utan

Queen Alexandra  
birdwing butterfly  
(female)

## Bursting with life

Tropical rainforests cover just 7% of Earth's land, yet contain over half of the world's species.



**Beetles** One scientist found 18,000 species of beetles in one small area of rainforest.



**Trees** A football pitch-sized patch of rainforest may contain 300 trees.



**Orchids** New orchids are continually being discovered in rainforests.



**Birds** The Amazon alone contains a third of Earth's 9,000 known bird species.

Slipper  
orchid